

VPA IGCSE ICT — Year 10 Semester 2 Assessment Pack

Victoria Park Academy Shenzhen

IGCSE ICT (0417) — Year 10 Semester 2 Assessment Pack

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1. ASSESSMENT OVERVIEW

This semester focuses on consolidation, mock examination series, and final examination preparation. All new content was delivered in Year 9 and Year 10 Semester 1. This semester is dedicated to:

Practical skill consolidation across all three papers

Theory revision and retrieval practice

Three full mock examinations under exam conditions

Gap analysis and targeted intervention

Final examination preparation and confidence building

Examination Structure (CIE 0417)

Paper 1 — Theory (2 hours, 100 marks, 40%)

Paper 2 — Document Production, Data Manipulation & Presentations (2.5 hours, 80 marks, 30%)

Paper 3 — Data Analysis, Website Authoring & Databases (2.5 hours, 80 marks, 30%)

2. SEMESTER ASSESSMENT CALENDAR

Week	Assessment	Type	Marks	Duration
Week 3	Theory Consolidation Test (Syllabus 1 – 5)	Written	50	60 min
Week 5	Practical Consolidation Test (Document Production)	Practical	40	60 min
Week 7	Practical Consolidation Test (Data Manipulation)	Practical	40	60 min
Week 9	Practical Consolidation Test (Web Authoring)	Practical	40	60 min
Week 11	MOCK EXAM 1 — Paper 1 (Theory)	Formal Mock	100	2 hours
Week 13	MOCK EXAM 2 — Paper 2 (Practical)	Formal Mock	80	2.5 hours
Week 15	MOCK EXAM 3 — Paper 3 (Practical)	Formal Mock	80	2.5 hours

Week	Assessment	Type	Marks	Duration
Week 17	Final Theory Warm-Up Test	Written	50	60 min
Week 18	Final Practical Warm-Up	Practical	40	60 min

3. MOCK EXAM 1 — PAPER 1 (THEORY)

3.1 Specification

Attribute	Detail
Duration	2 hours (120 minutes)
Total Marks	100 marks
Syllabus Coverage	Topics 1 – 10 (all theory)
Format	Written examination — short answer, structured, and extended response questions
Conditions	Exam conditions — no notes, no phones, no internet

3.2 Question Breakdown

Section	Topic	Marks	Question Types
A	Types and Components of Computer Systems	15	Short answer, labelling diagrams
B	Input and Output Devices	10	Matching, scenario questions
C	Storage Devices and Media	10	Comparison, advantages/disadvantages
D	Computer Networks	15	Network diagrams, protocol questions
E	Data Types	10	Data type identification, validation
F	The Effects of Using ICT	15	Extended response, evaluation
G	Systems Analysis and Design	10	Flowcharts, system design
H	Safety and Security	10	Security scenarios, recommendations
I	Audience and Communication	5	Audience analysis, design principles

3.3 Sample Questions

Question 1 (2 marks) — State two differences between RAM and ROM.

Mark Scheme:

- ☐ RAM is volatile / ROM is non-volatile (1 mark)
- ☐ RAM can be read from and written to / ROM is read-only (1 mark)
- ☐ RAM is used for currently running programs / ROM stores BIOS/boot instructions (1 mark)

Any two valid differences accepted.

Question 2 (4 marks) — Describe the advantages and disadvantages of using a wireless network in a school.

Mark Scheme:

Advantages (up to 2 marks):

- ☐ No cables needed — easier to set up and move devices (1)
- ☐ Devices can connect from anywhere in the school (1)
- ☐ Cheaper infrastructure (no cabling costs) (1)

Disadvantages (up to 2 marks):

- ☐ Slower speeds than wired networks (1)
- ☐ Security risks — easier to intercept (1)
- ☐ Interference from other devices (1)
- ☐ Limited range — may need repeaters (1)

Question 3 (6 marks) — A company wants to implement a new database system. Explain the stages of systems analysis and design they should follow.

Mark Scheme (6 marks):

- ☐ Analysis — identify problem, gather requirements, investigate current system (1)
- ☐ Design — plan solution, create data structures, design input/output screens (1)
- ☐ Development / Implementation — build database, create forms, write queries (1)
- ☐ Testing — test with sample data, check for errors, user acceptance testing (1)
- ☐ Installation / Deployment — install on user computers, train staff (1)
- ☐ Documentation — user guide, technical guide, training materials (1)
- ☐ Maintenance — fix bugs, add features, update as needed (1)
- ☐ Evaluation — check against original requirements, identify improvements (1)

Any 6 stages with explanation = 6 marks

4. MOCK EXAM 2 — PAPER 2 (DOCUMENT PRODUCTION, DATA MANIPULATION & PRESENTATIONS)

4.1 Specification

Attribute	Detail
Duration	2 hours 30 minutes (150 minutes)
Total Marks	80 marks
Format	Practical examination — computer-based
Software	Microsoft Word, Excel, PowerPoint (or equivalent)
Conditions	Exam conditions — no internet, no pre-prepared files

4.2 Task Breakdown

Task	Software	Marks	Skills Tested
Task 1	Word Processor	30	Document production, formatting, styles, mail merge, tables
Task 2	Spreadsheet	30	Formulas, functions, charts, data manipulation, sorting, filtering
Task 3	Presentation	20	Slide design, transitions, animations, audience-appropriate content

4.3 Sample Task — Document Production (30 marks)

Scenario: A school is preparing a newsletter for parents. You need to create a professional document using the provided source files.

Requirements:

Create a newsletter with appropriate headings, subheadings, and body text (5 marks)

Apply consistent formatting using styles (5 marks)

Insert and format a table showing term dates (5 marks)

Import and position images with appropriate sizing and wrapping (5 marks)

Add page numbers, headers, and footers (5 marks)

Perform a mail merge to create personalised letters for 10 parents (5 marks)

4.4 Sample Task — Data Manipulation (30 marks)

Scenario: A sports shop has provided sales data. You need to analyse the data using a spreadsheet.

Requirements:

Import data from a CSV file and format appropriately (5 marks)

Create formulas to calculate totals, averages, and percentages (5 marks)

Use functions (SUM, AVERAGE, MAX, MIN, COUNTIF) (5 marks)

Create a chart showing sales trends (5 marks)

Sort and filter data to answer specific questions (5 marks)

Apply conditional formatting to highlight key data (5 marks)

4.5 Sample Task — Presentations (20 marks)

Scenario: Create a 5-slide presentation about healthy eating for a Year 6 audience.

Requirements:

Design a consistent slide master with appropriate colours and fonts (5 marks)

Create 5 slides with relevant content and images (5 marks)

Add appropriate transitions and animations (5 marks)

Ensure the presentation is suitable for the target audience (5 marks)

5. MOCK EXAM 3 — PAPER 3 (DATA ANALYSIS, WEBSITE AUTHORING & DATABASES)

5.1 Specification

Attribute	Detail
Duration	2 hours 30 minutes (150 minutes)
Total Marks	80 marks
Format	Practical examination — computer-based
Software	Spreadsheet, web browser/editor, database software
Conditions	Exam conditions — no internet, no pre-prepared files

5.2 Task Breakdown

Task	Software	Marks	Skills Tested
Task 1	Spreadsheet / Database	30	Data analysis, queries, reports, advanced formulas
Task 2	Web Editor	30	HTML, CSS, website structure, navigation, images
Task 3	Database	20	Table design, relationships, forms, queries, reports

5.3 Sample Task — Data Analysis (30 marks)

Scenario: A charity has provided donation data. You need to analyse the data and produce a report.

Import data and verify data types (5 marks)

Create calculated fields and summary statistics (5 marks)

Write queries to extract specific information (5 marks)

Create a report with grouping and totals (5 marks)

Produce charts to visualise the data (5 marks)

Export results in appropriate formats (5 marks)

5.4 Sample Task — Website Authoring (30 marks)

Scenario: Create a 3-page website for a local community centre.

Create a home page with navigation, heading, and content (5 marks)

Create an activities page with a table of events (5 marks)

Create a contact page with a form (5 marks)

Apply consistent CSS styling across all pages (5 marks)

Include images with appropriate alt text and sizing (5 marks)

Test all links and ensure the site is functional (5 marks)

5.5 Sample Task — Databases (20 marks)

Scenario: A library needs a database to track books and borrowers.

Design and create tables with appropriate data types and validation (5 marks)

Create a relationship between tables (5 marks)

Design a form for data entry (5 marks)

Create a query to find overdue books (5 marks)

6. GRADE BOUNDARIES

Based on typical CIE IGCSE ICT (0417) grade boundaries:

Grade	Paper 1 (%)	Paper 2 (%)	Paper 3 (%)	Overall (%)
A*	80 – 100	80 – 100	80 – 100	80 – 100
A	70 – 79	70 – 79	70 – 79	70 – 79
B	60 – 69	60 – 69	60 – 69	60 – 69
C	50 – 59	50 – 59	50 – 59	50 – 59
D	40 – 49	40 – 49	40 – 49	40 – 49
E	30 – 39	30 – 39	30 – 39	30 – 39
F	20 – 29	20 – 29	20 – 29	20 – 29
G	10 – 19	10 – 19	10 – 19	10 – 19

Note: Actual grade boundaries are set by CIE after each examination series and may vary.

7. PROGRESSION TRACKING TEMPLATE

Assessment	Date	Paper 1 /100	Paper 2 /80	Paper 3 /80	Total /260	%	Grade
Mock 1	Week 11	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____%	_____
Mock 2	Week 13	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____%	_____
Mock 3	Week 15	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____%	_____
Final IGCSE	TBC	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____%	_____

8. EAL SUPPORT FOR ASSESSMENTS

Before Each Assessment:

- ☐ Bilingual glossary of command words provided (State, Describe, Explain, Evaluate)
- ☐ Key vocabulary pre-taught one week before assessment
- ☐ Practice paper completed in advance with bilingual support
- ☐ Extra reading time allowed (where school policy permits)
- ☐ Clear, simple instructions on assessment paper
- ☐ Visual aids and diagrams used in question papers where possible

During Assessment:

- ☐ Bilingual dictionary available (if permitted by CIE regulations)
- ☐ Word bank for extended writing tasks
- ☐ Sentence starters for "Explain" and "Evaluate" questions
- ☐ Clear command word definitions at start of paper

After Assessment:

- [] Vocabulary from difficult questions reviewed
- [] Common errors discussed with bilingual explanations
- [] Individual feedback provided with specific improvement targets

9. EXAM TECHNIQUE GUIDE

Paper 1 — Theory

Time management: 100 marks in 120 minutes = 1.2 minutes per mark

Read the command word carefully: State (1 line), Describe (how it works), Explain (reasons why), Evaluate (advantages AND disadvantages)

Show all working for calculation questions

Use diagrams where appropriate — they can earn marks even if text is unclear

Answer all questions — no negative marking, so guess if unsure

Paper 2 & 3 — Practical

Read all tasks before starting — plan your time

Save your work frequently — every 10 minutes

Check file formats — save in the required format

Test everything — check links, formulas, print preview

Leave 10 minutes at the end for checking and saving

10. INTERVENTION PROTOCOL

Trigger	Intervention	Responsible	Timeline
<40% in any consolidation test	Small group revision session (3-5 students)	Class teacher	Within 1 week
<50% in any mock exam	1-to-1 gap analysis + targeted revision plan	Class teacher + HoD	Within 3 days
Consistent underperformance (<50% in 2+ assessments)	Parent meeting + individual tuition plan	HoD + Form tutor	Within 1 week
EAL student struggling with command words	Bilingual command word flashcards + extra practice	EAL coordinator	Ongoing
Practical skills weak	Extra supervised practice sessions	Class teacher	Weekly until improved

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